EBK-012 · Guides

Freelance negotiation scripts

Sentences for scope, price, and a late invoice.

MOHAO digital product

When they ask for more

'I can add that. It is outside the current price, so I will send a small extra before I start.' Then stop talking. Do not apologise for the boundary.

- Name that it is extra.
- Do not start the extra yet.
- Send the number in writing.

When they want it cheaper

'I can reduce the price by removing the second revision and the extra page.' Offer a smaller scope. Do not invent a discount with the same scope unless you have a reason you can say.

- Remove work.
- Say what was removed.
- Keep the written scope.

When the invoice is late

'Invoice 16 for R7,200 was due on 2 October. Please confirm the payment date this week.' Send it to the person who can pay. Be specific. Do not write a story about your rent.

- Number, amount, date.
- One request.
- A follow-up date.

When you should walk

If they refuse a written scope, refuse a deposit, or ask you to copy someone else's work, the script is a no. A polite no is a complete sentence.

- Written scope or no.
- Deposit or no.
- No copied work.